

HKSTP Ideation FAQ Pack

Bank Account Related

Q. What bank account should I register and can I change it?

- A. The Ideation grant will be disbursed according to the name on the grant agreement.
Individual members must provide their personal bank accounts to receive the grant even if you have incorporated a company during 2nd milestone, while company members must provide the company bank account.
You may update your bank account number if the bank of the beneficiary is the same as the name on the grant agreement.

Q. Will my programme's start date be affected if my bank account is not ready?

- A. You are only required to submit your bank registration within the programme period. However, your payments will only be processed to the finance team after you have signed the grant agreement and your bank registration has been approved. Please submit the bank registration as soon as your company bank account is ready.

Grant Agreement & Co-working Space

Q. Do we have working space in Science Park?

- A. Ideation members are only offered co-working space at Incubation Centre, which is located at InnoCentre in Kowloon Tong. The Operation Services Team should have sent you an email about activating the e-access card when your programme started. Kindly double-check your mailbox for the email.

Q. Who can have the access card for Incubation Centre (the Co-working Space)?

- A. For individual members, only 1 e-access would be granted and the access holder would be the PIC.
For company members, 2 e-access would be granted, one to PIC and one to a member listed on the application form.

Q. May I request for extra access for my team members?

- A. For company members, 2 e-access would be granted, one to PIC and one to a member listed on the application form.

2nd Milestone (Gold Badge)

Q. Who needs to present in the pitch video?

- A. The Person-In-Charge (PIC) should present in their own voice and show their face to convey commitment and passion. AI avatars or generated voices are not permitted in principle.

Q. For individual members, can I introduce new partners during the programme?

- A. You may update us your team member list during 2nd milestone when you are required to incorporate a company.

Q. Can I change my project?

- A. The purpose of Ideation is to support members in conducting market validation. If the result does not work as expected, you are allowed to make minor adjustments to pivot the plan. Support from Ideation will still continue after your pivot. However, if you would like to start over with a different project, you may need to end the current membership and apply Ideation with a different Ideation project.

3rd Milestone (Platinum Badge) & Conversion

Q. How can I pass 3rd milestone?

- A. If you can get a full approval for admission to the Incubation Programme/Incu-Bio Programme before your programme ends, you will be considered as fulfilling the 3rd milestone.

Q. How can I get an approval to apply for Incubation (Non-bio track)?

- A. Company members which passed the 2nd Milestone will be invited to a Level-up Bootcamp to prepare them for the 3rd milestone (conversion to Incubation). Without pre-approval granted from the Bootcamp, members will not be able to apply for the 3rd milestone in principle. For more information on Incubation, feel free to contact:
incubation@hkstp.org

Q. How can I get an approval to apply for Incu-Bio (Bio track)?

- A. Application for Incu-Bio is by invitation only. You may indicate your intent to convert to Incu-Bio and provide a pitch deck to us at:
ideation@hkstp.org
Our account manager will review your deck and if your progress is suitable, we will reach out for a call. For more information on Incu-bio, feel free to contact:
incubio@hkstp.org

Q. Can I graduate from 3rd milestone earlier?

- A. Early graduation from 3rd milestone (Platinum badge) is welcomed if your project has good progress, yet we expect you to pass 2nd milestone first to ensure you have validated the problem-solution fit.

Q. Can I change my project or company when applying for Incubation (Non-bio track)?

- A. You cannot change your project or company when applying for Incubation (minor change of your project is acceptable). If you want to use a different project, you will need to apply for Incubation via public track.

Q. What is the difference between Incubation (Non-bio track) and Incu-Bio (Bio track)?

- A. Please refer to the website for more details:
<https://www.hkstp.org/en/programmes/incubation>

Q. Does "2 full-time staff" include the founder? Can they be non-local staff?

- A. There are no restrictions on their roles (including founders) as long as there are 2 full-time staff **with permits to work in Hong Kong**. Please note that full-time students and professors cannot be counted as full-time staff. The Incubation application would require the employment contracts as proof of 2 full-time staff.

Q. How to prove the staff as a technical/R&D personnel?

- A. The team member(s) taking on the technical role is required to provide their academic certificate or transcript in R&D-related subjects. Please refer to the list below for the specific requirements:
https://www.itf.gov.hk/filemanager/en/content_89/RTH-TC%20Guide_en_Feb_2024.pdf

Grant Related

Q. May we use the grant we received during ideation to hire part-time staff? Do we need to submit the invoice for what we bought?

A. We do not have limitations on the purpose of the grant. You may use it according to your needs to help develop your product and market.

Q. I have received the payment advice but still haven't received the payment.

A. Please note the payment advice is just a notification of payment, and refer to the Payment Date on the payment advice instead of the Invoice Date.

Q. I still haven't received admission milestone (1st milestone) payment.

A. Please make sure that you have completed the bank registration on the portal and it was approved. If you have signed the grant agreement and the bank registration has been approved, the 1st milestone payment will be arranged in the 2nd month. If your bank registration has been rejected, please check the reject reason and re-submit again.

Q. How long would it take to receive the payment?

A. It typically takes up to 2 months for internal procedures including approving your bank registration and for Finance team to transfer the funding to your bank account.

Others

Q. Can we apply for other competitions and finance programmes?

A. We encourage Ideation members to look for other resources and funding to expand your business. However, please be reminded to check the terms and conditions of those competitions or programmes, as well as our terms and conditions to avoid double-dipping of funds.

Q. Is it possible to collaborate or merge teams in the same cohort if we are similar?

A. We regret that all teams are independent and cannot be merged.

Q. How do I graduate from this programme?

A. There are three badges of graduate for this programme participants when they stay in-programme until the programme end date. If you pass only the admission milestone, you will complete the programme as a Silver badge graduate. If you pass both the admission and 2nd milestones, you will complete the programme as a Gold badge graduate. If you pass all 3 milestones, you will complete the programme as a Platinum badge graduate. However, if you withdraw or are terminated within the programme period, you will not be qualified as a graduate.